



# The yfinance Python library

The `yfinance` is a Python library with a user-friendly interface for downloading historical market data from Yahoo Finance. It lets you get historical stock prices, dividends, and other financial data for stocks, exchange-traded funds (ETFs), and other securities.

This example shows code for using `yfinance` to download historical stock prices.

```
import yfinance as yf
# Download historical data for a stock
msft = yf.Ticker("MSFT")
msft_data = msft.history(period="max")
# Display the downloaded data
msft_data.head()
```

## Explanation for the above code:

- First, import the `yfinance` library using the alias `yf`.
- Then, create a `Ticker` object for the Microsoft stock ("MSFT").
- Use the `history` method of the `Ticker` object to download the historical data for the stock. The `period` parameter of the `history` method specifies when you want to download the data. In this example, it is set to `max` to download the maximum available historical data.

Here are some of the possible values for the `period` parameter and what they represent:

- `period="1d"`: Download 1 day of historical data.
- `period="5d"`: Download 5 days of historical data.
- `period="1mo"`: Download 1 month of historical data.

- `period="3mo"`: Download 3 months of historical data.
- `period="6mo"`: Download 6 months of historical data.
- `period="1y"`: Download 1 year of historical data.
- `period="2y"`: Download 2 years of historical data.
- `period="5y"`: Download 5 years of historical data.
- `period="10y"`: Download 10 years of historical data.
- `period="ytd"`: Download historical data since the beginning of the current year.
- `period="max"`: Download all available historical data.

Finally, you print the downloaded data using the `head` function. This downloaded data will display a Pandas data frame containing Microsoft's historical stock prices and other financial data.

|            | Open     | High     | Low      | Close    | Volume     | Dividends | Stock Splits |
|------------|----------|----------|----------|----------|------------|-----------|--------------|
| Date       |          |          |          |          |            |           |              |
| 1986-03-13 | 0.055241 | 0.063365 | 0.055241 | 0.060657 | 1031788800 | 0.0       | 0.0          |
| 1986-03-14 | 0.060657 | 0.063907 | 0.060657 | 0.062823 | 308160000  | 0.0       | 0.0          |
| 1986-03-17 | 0.062823 | 0.064448 | 0.062823 | 0.063907 | 133171200  | 0.0       | 0.0          |
| 1986-03-18 | 0.063907 | 0.064448 | 0.061740 | 0.062281 | 67766400   | 0.0       | 0.0          |
| 1986-03-19 | 0.062281 | 0.062823 | 0.060657 | 0.061198 | 47894400   | 0.0       | 0.0          |

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